

Lina Shahid 1000 words Assessment 1 - ACP601 Case Study Autism: Contemporary Practices

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ACP601 Case Study Autism: Contemporary Practices -1000 words

Institution: Torrens University

Introduction

This essay will address the support needs of Dom a 12 -year old child. Dom has been diagnosed with autism. The key issues will be analysed such as anxiety, social interaction, sensory issues. The development of learning support knowledge will be discussed in terms of teachers' awareness of autism and its symptoms and strategies available. Also, adapting the curriculum and ensuring a child's needs are met using inclusive education strategies.

Awareness

Autism awareness over time is becoming much more highlighted, understood, accepted and widespread in communities therefore more learning support knowledge is being acquired over the years. There are many strategies today that those with autism can utilise due to more awareness amongst educators and clinicians. There are now faster diagnosis' and thus an increase in autism being identified (Autism Spectrum Australia, 2012; Silberman, 2001).

Teacher training

Development of learning support knowledge in autism-

Many teachers do not have the training to be confident to ensure individuals with autism are included within their classroom and fail to identify symptoms of autism (Healy, 2013, McMurray, 2016, Sanahuja, 2016, Lakkala 2016). It appears that throughout Dom's school life his teachers have misunderstood his support needs possibly due to his teachers lacking awareness of best strategies for individuals with autism as Dom was displaying traits of autism

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(Healy 2013, McMurray 2016, Sanahuja 2016, Lakkala 2016). Forcing him to carry out homework is unnecessary and will be causing his anxiety. Dom could be given a different form of homework allowing him to film, dictate, type or draw his ideas rather than writing them.

Inclusive education

Educational experiences are important to all children via the inclusive education concept to ensure that they feel cherished, included and wanted (McMurray, 2016; Edutopia 2017). The barrier to inclusion is that many schools feel that they are not appropriately equipped to cater for those such as Dom's needs (McMurray, 2016; Sanahuja, 2016).

Key issues

Social interaction, anxiety: Strengths

Many individuals with autism have difficulties with social interactions such as Dom (Healy 2013; Amaze 2017; Erinclem 2013; Nall 2015; Gray 2014; Healy 2013; Hannah 2012; Raising Children (n.d). If Dom was able to make friends with the boy who enjoys cooking, then this could enhance and develop Dom's social skills and self-esteem by merging his strengths into his learning (VOA 2016; Bonnello 2015; Post 21 Club 2013). The speech and occupational therapist could introduce play- based therapy for Dom (Nall 2018) and focus on his interests such as cooking which is supported in Forbes (2017) as many have a hyper interest that they can excel in (Silberman 2001). Dom shouts out in class therefore this could be due to his lack of social awareness.

Many children experience anxiety and have a negative self -evaluation of themselves (Hannah 2012). To support Dom with his anxiety he could continue to be part of the social skills group but to try and focus on his interactions in the classroom and playground.

Support Needs in relation to school experiences

Curriculum

Dom participated in extra- curricular activities and these should continue to be worked upon (McMurray 2016; Arnaiz 2016). The issues highlight the need for schools to be flexible and inclusive to ensure that the needs of children such as Dom are met.

Cognitive behaviour therapy could be used for Dom which involves discussing feelings, reactions and relaxation strategies. This will aid Dom in making friends (Raising Children 2017).

Peer training can be used when children who are developing typically, integrate with those with autism such as Dom (Raising Children 2017). Dom could play with his sister but supervised as she is neuro-typical therefore she is able to model playing together. Dom could have self- management techniques to allow him to learn how to maintain his behaviour (Raising Children 2017).

Quiet room

Dom requires a safe place he can visit in the school, he enjoys music therefore he could have access to a quiet room (Raising Children 2017)

Sensory challenges- anxiety

Many individuals with autism have sensory difficulties (Healy, 2013, De Luca, Legge 2016). Dom refuses to go to the school assembly and if his teachers were experienced then they would realise this could be due to sensory issues such as noise in the hall. Dom could be given headphones to reduce the noise which could help with his anxiety (Ikuta 2016).

Adapting learning

Children need to be actively involved in their learning and more practical methods used (Arnaiz 2016). If Dom was choosing his learning based upon his interests cooking and music, he could be more engaged and become more socially active with peers in class. The curriculum should be delivered in an alternative method and alter the style of teaching to ensure that Dom achieves success (Arnaiz 2016). Edutopia (2017) refers to different ways of helping children learn by adapting the physical space. The teachers placed Dom at the front and this strategy did not work therefore the school could try different seating positions.

Appropriate tasks given to child

Children with autism will ask to be excluded from activities such as physical education if there are too difficult (Healy 2013). Teachers must find tasks that are pitched at Dom's level. This reasserts the view that teachers need more training in autism (Healy 2013, McMurray 2016, Sanahuja 2016, Lakkala 2016).

Involvement of carers

Parents are a child's best resource (Billington 2000). Dom's teachers must work in collaboration with Dom's parents. Barriers in educational experiences can impact an individual with autism and their carers. Many parents such as Dom's face many barriers to ensuring that their child's needs are met such as problems finding a school that can accommodate their child (Australian Broadcasting Corporation 2014, The Strait Times 2017).

Conclusion

In conclusion, the target for those with autism is the need to attain the correct skills, guidance and provision to achieve independence via different strategies (Wilczynski, 2013; Post 21 Club; Raising Children Network, 2017; Specialisterne Australia, 2016). Schools are becoming more equipped to help those children with autism as time develops (Lakkala 2016). The knowledge and support are becoming more advanced as society becomes more knowledgeable of how to implement effective strategies. If teachers are equipped with the necessary strategies such as using their strengths then they can cater for children such as Dom (VOA, 2016; Bonello, 2015; Post 21 Club, 2013). Solutions have been discussed such as a more training for teachers, adapting the curriculum, early diagnosis and involving carers. These collectively will address the needs of children such as Dom.

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